Tuesday: Emotional Awareness

- Students come in and do their daily check-in
    - Have visual schedule on the board
- Daily engagement (wordle, contexto,set game)
- Group activity for managing emotions
    - Read the situation on the board and let students answer what the person might do in the situation:
        - "I'm going to put a situation on the board. I want you to think, not about what emotion the person feels yet, but about what they might *do* in that moment. There's no wrong answer, we're just guessing together."
        - "If it's the same situation, why might two people react differently? [Pause for guesses.] A lot of the time, it comes down to the *feeling* underneath the action. What someone feels affects what they do, even when they don't realize it's happening."
- This leads into how emotions may affect how you act and how emotional awareness can help in these situations
    - "That's what we're focusing on today, not just what people *do*, but the feeling that's driving it. This is called **emotional awareness**, noticing what you're feeling, and noticing it *before* it turns into an action you didn't mean to do."
    - Being aware of how you are feeling can help how you respond to a situation
        - "Feelings happen fast, and sometimes we react before we even realize what we're feeling. But if you pause and notice 'hey, I'm feeling frustrated' or 'I'm feeling nervous,' that little bit of awareness gives you a moment to decide what to do next , instead of just reacting on autopilot."
        - It gives you a chance to use a calming/coping mechanism

    - There is a **reason** why you are feeling certain things:
        - Big emotions don't always feel good, but even uncomfortable emotions are trying to *help* us in some way, they're giving us information. Today's worksheet (emotional awareness worksheet) is about figuring out what that information is, and how each emotion can actually work *for* us instead of against us."
    - Read through worksheet instructions, have students answer question at the bottom:
        - give examples: **Fear/Nervousness** → *Keeps us safe or prepared.*
            - "If you feel nervous before a test, that's your brain telling you 'this matters, get ready.' That nervous feeling can actually push you to study or review your notes."
        - **Anger/Frustration** → *Signals something feels unfair or a boundary was crossed.*
            - "If you feel frustrated when a friend keeps interrupting you, that feeling is pointing out that something doesn't feel right, and it might be a signal to speak up or ask for space."
- We talked about how being aware of how you are feeling can affect your actions: when you notice a feeling before you react, you get a chance to choose your response instead of just reacting automatically.
- But noticing a feeling is only the first step. Sometimes, especially with big feelings, frustration, anxiety, anger, noticing isn't enough on its own. You also need a way to actually **calm** that feeling down before you can think clearly and choose your next move.
- That's where having a tool comes in. One simple tool is a short breathing or calming exercise, something you can use anytime a feeling starts to feel like too much. Let's

practice one right now, together, so it's already familiar for whenever you actually need it."

- Okay, now I want you to practice being aware of your emotions, you have a work sheet called “How might you feel”, I want you to read through these scenarios and write down how you might feel in these situations; you don't have to write this part down but I want you to think about what you might do to make yourself feel better in these situations or what your emotions in these situations mean
- After students have finished, they can hand in the worksheets and do any missing assignments